

Session 10: The Nazarene

Key Takeaways

- Quoting from Hosea, who himself frames Israel's situation in the language and imagery of the exodus, Matthew continues the tradition of interpreting current events through the lens of Israel's Scriptures.
- The deeper layers of meaning Matthew constructs through these references enrich the more direct parts of his message. The text offers much from a simple reading, and it holds riches for a lifetime of deep meditation.
- The term *Nazoraïos* (Nazarene, Matt. 2:23) may connect Jesus to the promise of a "branch/shoot" from the line of David (Isa. 11:1), or it may link him to the Nazirite vow (Num. 6:1-21), a most holy commitment. The ambiguity may invite us to make both comparisons.



This session covers the notes from session 9

Reflection Question

Do Matthew's quotations help or hinder your understanding of his message? Do you need to understand all of the references to understand what he is trying to tell you?